Ferrari organised a special unveiling for Thakkar's 12Cilindri Spider at the rooftop of the St Regis hotel in Mumbai. "The delivery experience is also customised. They hand over the car in a fancy way," he says.

Since gold has long held an enduring allure for India's wealthy, Volkswagen-owned British luxury marque Bentley often gets client requests for gold-plated Flying B, its century-old mascot. In heavily custom-made Bentley cars, customers often replace the Winged-B Bentley logo on the headrest with their initials, embroidered motifs or even a family crest, says Sagar Karkhanis, lead of sales and marketing, Bentley India.

Under the marque's Mulliner programme, customers have the option of taking a trip to Bentley's factory in Crewe, UK, or getting on a virtual session with designers to configure the car.

At Bentley, a customer on average spends over ₹60 lakh on personalisation. For the Super Sports model, a customer spent almost the price of the car, ₹8 crore (ex-showroom).

At German carmaker Mercedes-Benz, every customer wants a distinctive Maybach. To meet their wishes, Maybach sends a trolley bag with basic customisation options such as paint, veneer, and wood to their homes. "India is one of the highest markets for individualisation; 75% of G-Wagon and Maybach cars sold in India are customised and personalised," says Santosh Iyer, Managing Director and CEO, Mercedes-Benz India. "Nobody wants their car to look the same as the neighbour's," says Iyer.

The amount spent on customisation can go up to twice the price of the car, says Iyer. "For the Maybach S Class, it can cost an additional ₹3.5 crore. "On average, people spend ₹50-60 lakh on customisation across G-Class, S Class and GLS Maybach," says Iyer, adding that personalisation can start from paints and can go up to artisan stitched seatbelts, seats, and carpeting.

As delivery of a bespoke Maybach could take more time, some wealthy Indians don't mind paying top dollar to airlift the rides. "Even if the waiting period is six months, they don't mind. But when we inform that the car is ready, some spend ₹40 lakh to airlift it, because they want it the next day," says Iyer.

Mercedes-Benz's G Class special edition offered engraving of initials or family name on the grab handles. "It cost an additional ₹4.5 lakh as it was handmade in Europe," says Iyer. Only 30 such units were allocated for India.

BMW top-end and M vehicles are priced around ₹1.5–2.6 crore, while highly bespoke commissions can add the equivalent of 60–70% of the vehicle's value. BMW, which has a dedicated customisation programme called 'BMW Individual', sees the strongest demand for custom-made cars from buyers of the carmaker's flagship and high-performance models, particularly the BMW 7 Series and BMW M cars. Some select a distinctive paint, upholstery or trim, while others commission a complete exterior-and-interior theme. Through BMW Individual, customers commission engraved or embroidered initials, signatures, family crests and other insignia.

At Audi, customers spend ₹50–70 lakh on customisation of top-end models such as Audi Q8, SQ8 and Audi RS Q8, says Balbir Singh Dhillon, Brand Director of Audi India. "One notable example is an Audi RS Q8 owner from Bhubaneswar who opted for 17 customisation choices, the highest number recorded at Audi India, including an exclusive Java Green paint finish priced at ₹12.29 lakh. Another customer from Coimbatore personalised his Audi RS e-tron GT with options worth ₹36 lakh, including the RS Styling Package, a carbon fibre roof, black styling elements, all-wheel steering and Matrix LED headlights with



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